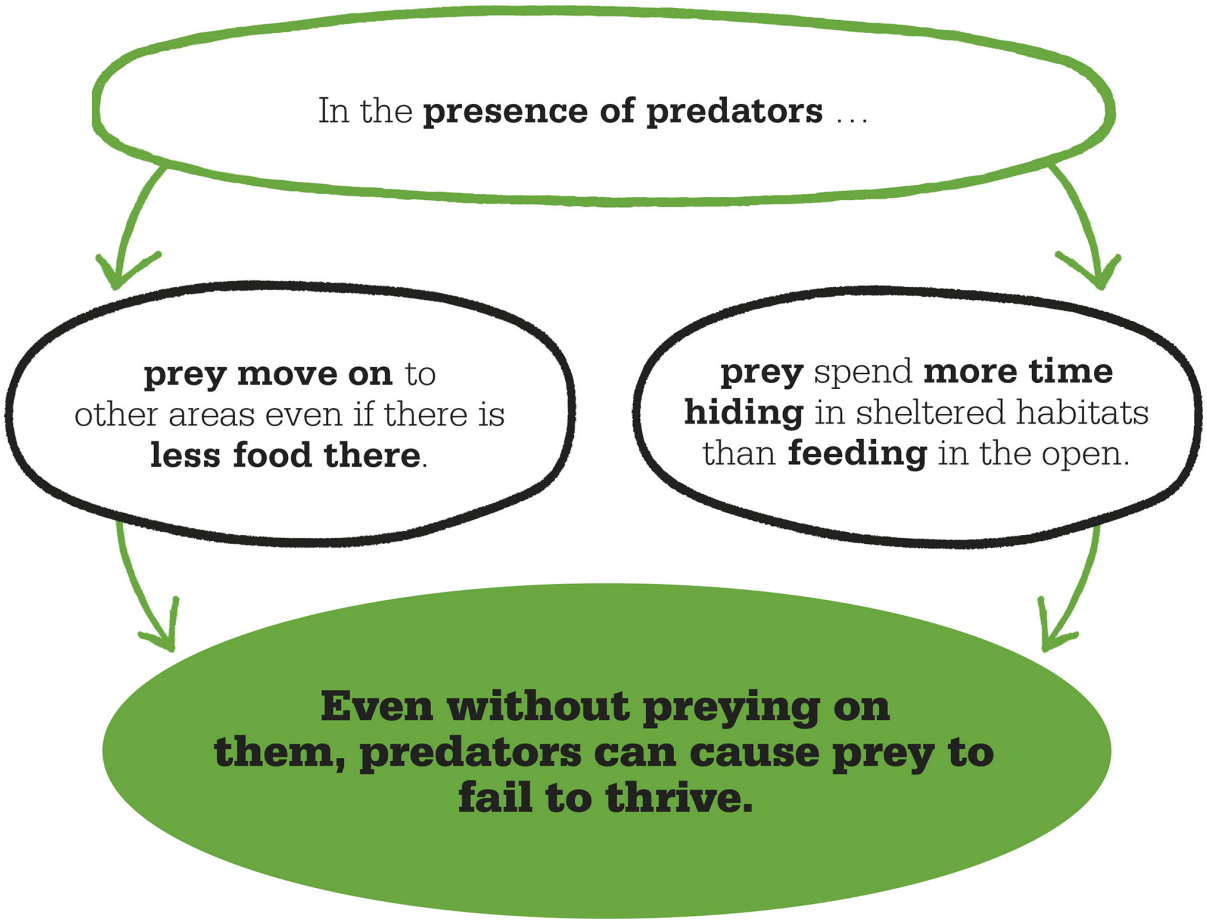


Read accessible description

Terrestrial animals

Early studies of nonconsumptive effects (NCEs) were concerned with aquatic organisms under laboratory conditions, but more work has now been done in the wild with land-dwelling animals. German field research published in 2018 focused on lynx and their roe deer prey. When lynx were present, researchers found that the roe deer avoided areas they knew to be high-risk, both during the day and on summer nights when nocturnal predation is more common. The deer treated some grazing areas as out of bounds, presumably due to fear of being attacked by lynx.

Wherever there are predators, they exert NCEs. They also affect some sessile (nonmoving) species, as well as mobile prey. This can happen when